SS-J-570B
August 9, 1977
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. SS-J-570A
October 24, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

JOINT COMPOUNDS AND TAPE, WALLBOARD (FOR GYPSUM WALLBOARD CONSTRUCTION)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers joint compound and tape for finishing, joints in gypsum wallboard construction.

1.2 Classification. The joint compounds and joint tape shall be of the following types, styles, and classes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Joint Compound
  Style 1 - Drying Powder
    Class A - Taping.
    B - Topping.
    C - All purpose.

  Style 2 - Hardening Powder
    Class A - Taping.
    B - Topping.
    C - All Purpose.

  Style 3 - Drying, premixed paste
    Class A - Taping.
    B - Topping.
    C - All purpose.

Type II - Joint Tape
  Style 1 - Plain.
  2 - Perforated.

1.2.1 Sizes. Joint compound and joint tape materials shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Joint compound.
  Style 1 - 5, 25, and 50 pounds.
  2 - 5, 25, and 50 pounds.
  3 - 12.5, 50, and 62 pounds.

Type II - Joint Tape.

  Styles 1 and 2 - lengths of 60, 250, 375, and 500 feet, in rolls.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

FSC 5640

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Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes Setup.
PPP-C-96 - Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter.
UU-S-48 - Sacks, Shipping, Paper.
PPP-P-1655 - Pail, Plastic, Shipping and Storage.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, **Houston**, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

C 474 - Testing Joint Treatment Materials for Gypsum Wallboard Construction.
C 475 - Specification for Joint Treatment Materials for Gypsum Wallboard Construction.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Joint compound. Joint compound shall conform to the physical requirements of ASTM C 475. Asbestos fibers shall not be used as a filler in joint compounds.

3.2 Joint tape. Tape shall conform to the physical properties of ASTM C 475, except that tape shall be plain or perforated as specified (see 1.2). When perforated, there shall be a minimum of four holes across the width of the tape with an edge distance of not less than 3/8 inch. Spacing of holes lengthwise of the tape shall be 3/8 inch to 1/2 inch. The hole dimensions shall be 0.060 inch ± 0.015 inch.

3.3 Workmanship. Joint compound shall be free of lumps and extraneous particles. Tape shall not be torn or damaged.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsible for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination of end item. Sampling for examination of end item shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, level S-4.

4.2.2 For Test. Sampling for test shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, level S-2. The acceptance quality level (AQL's) shall be 2.5 percent. The sample size shall be not less than a 5-lb sample for joint compound, and not less than one 60 feet roll of joint tape, for the test.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 End item. Joint materials shall be examined for defects listed in table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for defects shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects.

TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Defects	Major	Minor
Lumps in joint compound	X	
Extraneous particles in joint compound	X	
Tape torn or damaged	X	
Width of tape less than 1-7/8 or greater than 2-1/4 inch	X	
Thickness of tape greater than 0.012 inch	X	
Damage or defects affecting function or serviceability	X	
Damage or defects not affecting function or serviceability		X

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not correct weight.
Workmanship	Inadequate or improper closure of containers. Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.4 Test.

4.4.1 Joint compound. The joint compounds shall be tested in accordance with test specified in ASTM C 474 (see 3.1).

4.4.2 Joint tape. The joint tape shall be tested in accordance with test specified in ASTM C 474 (see 3.2).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Type I, style 1, 2 or 3 joint compound. Style 1 or 2 powder shall be packaged in a sack conforming to UU-S-48. Top closure shall be in accordance with the requirements as specified in the sack specification. Style 3, premixed paste. The 62 pound quantities shall be packaged in a pail conforming to PPP-C-96 for metal cans and PPP-P-1655, type 1, grade GP for plastic pails. When specified (see 6.2), the 50 pound quantities shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. A polyethylene liner closed by a tie wire shall be provided within the container. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specifications.

5.1.2 Type II, style 1 or 2, tape. Style 1 or 2 shall be individually packaged in a close fitting box conforming to variety 2 of PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676, or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The fiberboard box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Commercial packaging. The compound or tape shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The packaging shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Level A. The compound or tape of the same type and style in quantities as specified (see 6.2), shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The pails of compound require no additional packing.

5.3.2 Commercial packing. The compound or tape shall be packed in containers to insure safe delivery or destination, to provide for safe redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification Rules or Uniform Freight Classification Rules.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Joint compound and tape are intended for use in treating joints of gypsum wallboard.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, style, and class (see 1.2.1, 6.3, 6.4, and 6.5).
(c) Size (see 1.2.2).
(d) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Conditions for use of levels B preservation and packing (see 5.1.2).
(g) Fiberboard box requirements for 50 pound quantities (see 5.1 and 5.1.2).
(h) Quantities of unit packages of compound or tape in shipping container (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2).

6.3 Type I, style 1, joint compound. Type I, style 1, joint compound, when used with reinforcing tape, comprises a system for treating joints of gypsum wallboard. The regular finish produced is satisfactory for general requirements. It may also be used as a laminating adhesive in double wallboard construction and for concealing nailheads.

6.4 Type I, style 2, joint compound. Type I, style 2, joint compound is used for embedding tape, drywall, fasteners, and metal accessories. It can be used for heavy fills, but not for finishing.

6.5 Type I, style 3, joint compound. Type I, style 3, joint compound is a premixed paste ready for application. When used with reinforcing tape, it comprises a system for finishing joints of gypsum wallboard producing a smooth finish. It may also be used for concealing nailheads.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Custodians:

Army - ME
Navy - YD
Air Force - 99

Review:

Army - ME, CE
Navy - YD
Air Force - 99

User:

Navy - MC
Army - CE

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Military Coordinating Activity:

Army - ME

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA-FSS-PCD
COM-NBS
HUD-TCS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price cents each.

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